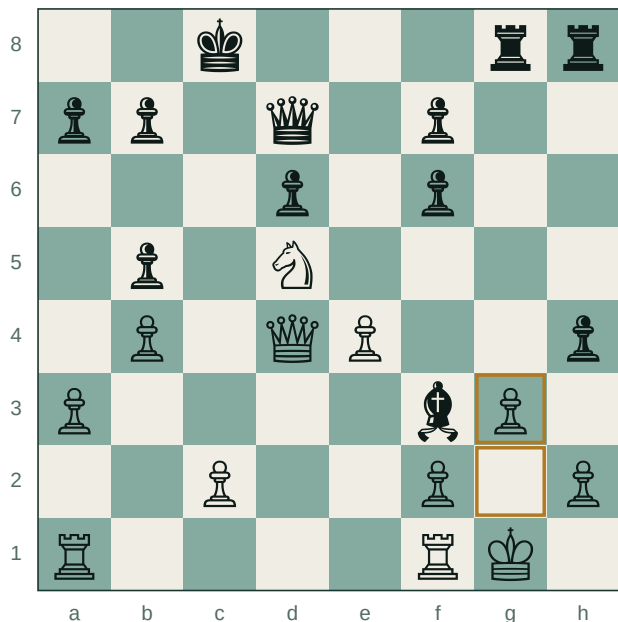


Active defensive resources: Black, move 20

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 20.g3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20...Qh3 21. Qc3+ Kb8 22. Qc7+ Ka8 23. Qd8+ Rxd8

20...Qh3 The queen moves from d7 to h3. Recorded reply: **21.Qc3+**.

21...Kb8 The king moves from c8 to b8. Recorded reply: **22.Qc7+**.

22...Ka8 The king moves from b8 to a8. Recorded reply: **23.Qd8+**.

23...Rxd8 The rook captures the queen on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 20 / Black 29 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from +0 to +9. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: pawn on g3.